

Guide Proposal

For submission to the How-To Guide platform

Proposed Title

Batch Financial Report Processing for VAs, Part 2: Consolidation

What the Guide Teaches

A VA learns to set up and run a tool that reads a batch of text-based transaction report files, parses the transaction data out of them, and consolidates everything into one formatted Excel master sheet with a summary tab, with sensitive account and card numbers masked by default throughout. Pairs with Part 1: Extraction as a complete pipeline, but works fully standalone.

Outline

- Decision boundaries: what the VA decides versus what needs client sign-off
- Security spotlight: why sensitive fields are masked by default, and when that's allowed to change
- Requirements checklist before starting
- One-time computer setup (automatic installer for Python and openpyxl)
- Step-by-step configuration, loading, and reviewing data
- Exporting the Excel master sheet and understanding its two tabs
- Troubleshooting common issues
- Appendix covering every file included with the guide

Format

PDF guide plus three supporting files: a one-click setup script, a one-click launcher, and the tool itself. A plain-text Notepad-based install walkthrough is included for VAs who receive the files as pasted text rather than downloads.

Why This Fits the Program's Requirements

- Original: adapted from a production process built from scratch, not copied from any existing source.
- Teaches a repeatable process a VA can run independently once set up.
- Explicitly separates VA-level actions from owner-level decisions throughout, rather than assuming the reader is the business owner.

- Builds in a genuine security safeguard (default data masking) rather than treating sensitive financial data the same as any other column.

Question Before Submission

Before finalizing this submission, I'd like to confirm the terms of sale: is this a non-exclusive purchase, and would I retain the right to reference having created this guide (for example, in a personal portfolio or job application) after it's purchased? Happy to proceed once this is clarified.

Supporting Materials

Updated CV

[Attach current CV here before submitting. Emphasize the production systems background: five years as sole IT resource for a cooperative serving 7,000+ member accounts, direct experience building the transaction processing system this guide is based on.]

Video Introduction

[Attach video introduction here before submitting.]